SAGE, version 1: a modular heterogeneous-agent model of material, social, security and place wellbeing for France, Germany and Italy

Model note, draft for methods review

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Abstract. I describe version 1 of SAGE, a one-asset Bewley economy in partial equilibrium, calibrated to France, Germany and Italy, in which three dimensions of wellbeing can be switched on and off above a standard base. The base (G) has incomplete markets, uninsured income risk, job loss with a first insured year and a state of longer joblessness, a means-tested minimum income and hours set by the job. Social participation (S) is a logit choice with a social multiplier. Agency and security (A) adds anticipatory dread of job loss in the sense of Kőszegi and Rabin, costly job search with the curvature estimated by DellaVigna and co-authors, and chosen hours for those who control their working time. Place and environment (E) distributes households across regions or types of place, which differ in access to work, joblessness, commuting and community life, and values air quality in a wellbeing account. Every parameter is either a published estimate read at its source, an official statistic, or fitted to a named moment. Switched off, each dimension returns the model without it exactly. All twelve configurations hit their targets. The response of job finding to benefits has no moral hazard within the spell and comes out at about half the literature's, and the search cost the model needs stays below the measured life-satisfaction cost of unemployment. Three gaps are stated rather than forced: the fall in consumption on job loss is about three times the Swedish register estimate for those still out of work, the response of job finding to benefits is about half the literature's, and the marginal propensity to consume is in range but misordered across countries. The state of long joblessness is too persistent, which is likely to explain part of the first gap. Version 2 moves to a quarterly period and two assets.

1. Introduction

Most heterogeneous-agent models treat wellbeing as consumption and leisure. The literature on wellbeing beyond income, from the life-satisfaction evidence on unemployment to the measurement frameworks of statistical offices, points to other things that matter: taking part in the life of one's community, security against falls in living standards, and the place one lives in. In my master's thesis I built a Bewley model with these dimensions in a stylised form (Conway 2020). This note documents its first version fit for scrutiny: calibrated to three euro-area economies, with each dimension resting on a declared theory and a published estimate, and with the base reproducing standard macroeconomic facts.

The model is modular by design. G is a standard incomplete-markets economy. S, A and E are switches, and two rules govern them. First, a dimension brings its own theory and parameters and nothing else, and switched off it returns G exactly. Second, each dimension acts through behaviour, through wellbeing, or both, and its strength in each comes from data, never from tuning. Following Lima de Miranda and Snower (2020), each dimension is its own term in household wellbeing, which changes choices where its argument depends on them and changes wellbeing only where it does not.

Version 1 is deliberately limited to one asset and partial equilibrium, in the spirit of the partial-equilibrium analysis in Kaplan and Violante (2014). I would argue that this is the right first step. It lets the household side be checked against micro evidence before prices are endogenised, and it keeps every mechanism legible. Section 8 sets out what version 2 adds and which gaps it is expected to close.

2. The base economy (G)

2.1 Households

Households live forever and maximise expected discounted utility over consumption c and time use T:

$$u(c,T) = \frac{c^{1-\gamma}}{1-\gamma} - \phi\frac{T^{1+\psi}}{1+\psi},$$

with $\gamma = 2$ and $\psi = 1/0.143$, the Frisch elasticity estimated from Swedish lottery winners by Cesarini, Lindqvist, Notowidigdo and Östling (2017, Table 5), which I transfer to the three countries. The weight ϕ is fitted (Section 5). Time is $T = (1+\kappa_p)e + \bar{q}d$, where e is hours of paid work, κ_p is commuting time per unit of work in place p (zero nationally), and $\bar{q}d$ is the time taken by social participation $d \in \{0,1\}$ when S is on, set to measured time use (HETUS 2010).

Households hold one liquid asset $a \geq 0$ with gross real return R, the mean real return on overnight household deposits from 2003 to 2021 (ECB MFI interest rate statistics): 0.986, 0.991 and 0.989 in France, Germany and Italy. There are two education cells (below tertiary and tertiary), five permanent income types and, within each cell, one discount factor: $\bar{\beta}$ for the tertiary cell and $\bar{\beta} - \Delta\beta$ for the other.

2.2 Income and employment

Each household is employed (E), in a first year out of work (U) or beyond a year out of work (L), the three-state structure of McKay and Reis (2016). The employment transition matrix is

$$\Pi_{emp} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & f & 1-f \\ \delta_g & 1-\delta_g & 0 \\ 0 & f_g^L & 1-f_g^L \end{pmatrix},$$

with rows and columns ordered (U, E, L). The job-finding rate f is the annual flow from unemployment to employment in the Labour Force Survey (Eurostat `lfsi_long_a`, 2023): 0.549, 0.639 and 0.443. Job loss

δ_g is set so that each cell's unemployment rate (OECD Education at a Glance 2023) holds. The exit from the long-term state f_g^L follows in closed form from the share of adults in very-low-work-intensity households by education (Eurostat `ilc_lvhl14n`). Two features of this mapping matter for what follows. The LFS flow is measured among all the unemployed, whatever their duration, while the model assigns it to the first year alone, and the long-term state is built from household joblessness, which includes inactive adults, not from the duration of unemployment. Both make the long-term state more persistent than unemployment is: the implied mean stay in it is 1.5 to 4.6 years in France and Italy and 11 to 14 years in Germany, and its share of the out of work (63%, 83% and 69%) is well above the share of the unemployed out of work for a year or more (Eurostat `une_ltu_a`, 2023: 25%, 31% and 55%). I return to this in Section 8.

Earnings are $w = \alpha_g z \zeta e$, where α_g is relative pay by education (Structure of Earnings Survey 2022), ζ the permanent type and z a persistent AR(1) component with a transitory shock, both by education, from the estimates for each country of Ampudia, Cooper, Le Blanc and Zhu (2024, Table 16 of the working-paper version). Those estimates measure household income including spells out of work, which the model adds separately. I therefore purge them: the standard deviations of the persistent and transitory innovations are resolved so that model household income, job loss included, has the published variance and first autocovariance, with the persistence kept. The persistent component is discretised on 11 Rouwenhorst states and the transitory one on three.

2.3 Government

In the first year out of work a household receives the household-weighted net replacement rate for months 1 to 12 from OECD TaxBEN 2023 (0.72, 0.70, 0.70), of which the state pays the part net of a partner's earnings (0.50, 0.48, 0.47). In the long-term state household income is a share of what the household would earn, the measured ratio of median equivalised income in jobless households to that in other households (Eurostat `ilc_di07`: 0.48, 0.51, 0.44). A means-tested floor tops every household's resources up to the official minimum income, a share of median disposable income (OECD TaxBEN: 0.36, 0.37, 0.40), applied to the model's own median. The state's outlays (the insured part of benefits, the floor) are financed by a proportional tax on labour income that balances the budget.

2.4 Hours

In G hours are set by the job, not by the household. Each income state has one level of hours, found in a reference economy without the floor or the transitory shock, at which the household's first-order condition for hours holds on average in that state. The level does not respond to the household's wealth or to policy, which is the point: in most jobs hours are not chosen. Section 3.2 relaxes this for those who control their working time.

3. The three dimensions

3.1 S: social participation

With S on, each household chooses each year whether to take part in community life. Taking part costs time $\bar{q}$ and yields a belonging payoff

$$\Lambda \, \kappa \, m \, B_g \, [\omega + (1 - \omega) r],$$

where r is the aggregate participation rate, m an idiosyncratic taste drawn from a lognormal with dispersion σ_m, B_g the measured share of the cell with someone to ask for help (EU-SILC 2015, `ilc_scp15`, normalised to mean one), κ the strength of the social technology and $\omega = 0.3$ the part of the payoff that does not depend on others. $\Lambda = 1$ is a normalisation. The choice is logit with a small scale (0.005), in the tradition of Brock and Durlauf (2001). Because the payoff rises with r, participation has a social multiplier. The equilibrium is the highest stable crossing of the aggregate participation map with the 45-degree line, found on a grid of 401 values of r. Participation among the unemployed is reported at a measured multiple of the employed rate (0.56, 0.55, 0.94), imposed when results are added up. Inside the household problem, however, the unemployed choose freely, and because they work no hours and the disutility of time is nearly flat at low hours (a Frisch elasticity of 0.143), taking part costs them almost nothing, so in the household problem they take part at about one half whatever their belonging. The search decisions of the unemployed therefore answer to a participation rate that is not the one reported. No result in this note rests on that choice. The evidence suggests the measured ratio mostly reflects who becomes unemployed rather than what unemployment does: within the person, job loss does not change volunteering in the German panel (Kunze and Suppa 2017), while across European countries the unemployed are about half as likely to take part in formal groups as the employed in a single cross-section (Dieckhoff and Gash 2015). Valuing participation time apart from paid work, with a status-specific cost fitted to the within-person evidence, is part of version 2.

3.2 A: agency and security

A has three parts.

Dread of job loss, in choices. Following Kőszegi and Rabin (2009) as applied to consumption by Pagel (2017), a household anticipates the coming year's employment lottery. The anticipatory loss is

$$D(s, a') = \eta(\lambda - 1) \, q_s (1 - q_s) \, [u(Ra' + y_s^{hi}) - u(Ra' + y_s^{lo})],$$

where q_s is the chance of a change of employment status next year and y^{hi}, y^{lo} are next year's incomes in the two outcomes. The weight $\eta(\lambda - 1) = 1.5$ is Pagel's calibration ($\eta = 1$, $\lambda = 2.5$, p. 899), with her structural estimates ($\eta = 1.16$, $\lambda = 3.11$, Table 1) giving 2.45 as the top of a band. Dread falls as savings rise, so it enters the Euler equation and households save partly for peace of mind. Three choices about this term should be stated. First, it applies in every state that faces a change next year: in work (the chance of losing the job) and out of it (the chance of finding one). Second, the lottery a household dreads is set by the measured transition rates, not by its own search effort, so it is a reference lottery fixed outside the household's choice. This is why the search condition below contains no derivative of dread, and a version in which the

reference moves with search is listed for version 2. Third, utility is evaluated at next year's resources rather than at next year's optimal consumption, a simplification of Pagel's news utility over consumption that keeps the term a function of the current choice of savings alone.

Job search. Out of work, a household chooses $x \in [0, 1]$, its chance of finding work next year, at utility cost $k_{g,j}x^{1+\gamma_s}/(1+\gamma_s)$, $j \in \{U, L\}$. The curvature $\gamma_s = 0.35$ is the estimate of DellaVigna, Lindner, Reizer and Schmieder (2017, Table I, column 1) in the standard model with savings. Each searching state's row of the transition matrix is split into its part towards work and the rest, which the chosen x reweights:

$$x^* = \min\left\{\left(\frac{\beta\left[EV_f(a') - EV_s(a')\right]}{k}\right)^{1/\gamma_s}, 1\right\}.$$

The four cost levels per country (two cells, two states) are fitted so that the mean chances equal the measured f and f_g^L. The response of job finding to benefits is then an untargeted test (Section 7.2).

Hours for those who control them. A share of each cell chooses its hours freely: the measured share of employed people who can fully decide when their working day starts and ends (Eurostat `lfso_19fxwt01`, 2019: 0.15 and 0.25 in France, 0.16 and 0.31 in Germany, 0.15 and 0.19 in Italy). On the floor such a household works zero hours unless working lifts it above the floor and is worth more. The statistic measures control over when the working day starts and ends, not over its length, so it is a proxy for control over hours, and the margin it opens (down to zero hours on the floor) is the model's assumption, not something the statistic shows.

3.3 E: place and environment

With E on, the economy is a set of places, either the OECD TL2 regions (14 in France, 16 in Germany, 21 in Italy) or the three types of place of the degree of urbanisation. Places share national parameters and differ only through measured channels: the education composition, access to work (the flow into employment and the unemployment rate), the share of jobless households (which sets the exit from the long-term state locally), commuting time (types of place only) and community infrastructure, which scales the independent part of the belonging payoff with an elasticity of 0.4. Taxes and the floor are financed nationally. Households do not move between places in version 1. With every place identical, the place economy reproduces the national one to about 10^{-11}.

3.4 What is not in the base, and why

Two channels were built and left out by rules set before the results. A conversion channel (a place's income per head entering resources) broke the order of regional poverty in France and stays an option. Housing tenure, which separates the hand-to-mouth by place in the HFCS, needs two assets and waits for version 2. The cost of being out of work beyond the income lost (Section 4) was built as a term in choices and tested. At its life-satisfaction size it lowered the response of job finding to benefits to a third or a half of even the liquidity part of the evidence. I count it in wellbeing only.

4. The wellbeing account

The account reports, per head and per year, what each dimension's own term is worth, in life-satisfaction points on the 0 to 10 scale and as a share of consumption. One bridge serves every term: the HM Treasury (2021) supplementary Green Book guidance, under which a share x of income lost is worth $\beta_Y \ln(1-x)$ points with $\beta_Y = 1.961$. Terms that come from the model are turned into points, and terms that come from the evidence are turned into shares.

term	dimension	value	source
dread of a change of status	A	model consumption equivalent, everyone facing a change next year	model
out of work beyond income	A	the ESS gap at the same income decile, 1.05 to 1.06 points; 0.8 as a low end	ESS rounds 6, 7, 10, 11; Clark, Knabe and Rätzel (2010)
of which: job search	A	model consumption equivalent, those out of work	model
taking part	S	0.055 to 0.081 points per participant; the model's own belonging shown beside it	Meier and Stutzer (2008), fixed effects
air quality	E	0.3% to 0.8% of income per µg/m³ of PM2.5 above 5 µg/m³	Menz and Welsch (2010); OECD regional PM2.5; WHO (2021)
commuting	E	check only: already a time cost in the model	Stutzer and Frey (2008)

The conversions are as follows. For a model term, each household's consumption equivalent is the share x_i of the year's consumption with $u(c_i(1-x_i)) = u(c_i) - D_i$, where D_i is the term's utility cost. The shares are averaged over the stationary distribution, $\bar{x} = \sum_i \lambda_i x_i$, and converted once, at that mean, into $\beta_Y \ln(1-\bar{x})$ points. For a term from the evidence, a gap of g points is the share $1 - \exp(-g/\beta_Y)$. The averaging comes before the logarithm, which slightly understates the points where shares are dispersed. The life-satisfaction gap of the unemployed is measured among those looking for work, so it includes the strain of searching. The account shows the gap as the whole cost of being out of work beyond income and the model's search cost beside it. The two are not defined on the same basis, since one is a regression coefficient and the other a model consumption equivalent, so I read the search cost staying below the gap as a consistency bound, not as a decomposition. For S, the account reports the model's own belonging, the share of consumption that losing the belonging part of lifetime value would cost, beside the external estimate, so that the size of the

payoff behind the interaction in Section 7.3 can be compared with the evidence. The terms are not summed: weights across dimensions are a later step, for which I plan to use the Better Life Index users' own rankings by country.

5. Calibration

Table 1 lists what is set directly from official statistics or published estimates. Table 2 lists what is fitted, and to which moment. The household moments come from the Eurosystem Household Finance and Consumption Survey, wave 2021, for households not in retirement, used only as aggregate tables.

Table 1. Set from data (France, Germany, Italy).

	FR	DE	IT	source
job finding f	0.549	0.639	0.443	Eurostat `lfsi_long_a`, 2023
exit from long-term state f^L, by cell	0.216, 0.685	0.071, 0.093	0.250, 0.247	closed form from `ilc_lvhl14n`
replacement rate, first year (household; state)	0.72; 0.50	0.70; 0.48	0.70; 0.47	OECD TaxBEN 2023
long-term income over others'	0.48	0.51	0.44	Eurostat `ilc_di07`
minimum income, share of median	0.36	0.37	0.40	OECD TaxBEN 2023
gross real return	0.986	0.991	0.989	ECB MIR, 2003 to 2021
control over working time, by cell	0.15, 0.25	0.16, 0.31	0.15, 0.19	Eurostat `lfso_19fxwt01`
Frisch elasticity	0.143	0.143	0.143	Cesarini et al. (2017), transfer
dread weight $\eta(\lambda-1)$	1.5	1.5	1.5	Pagel (2017)
search curvature γ_s	0.35	0.35	0.35	DellaVigna et al. (2017)
income process	by education			Ampudia et al. (2024), purged

Table 2. Fitted, and to what.

parameter	moment	configurations
hours weight ϕ	mean paid-work share of the employed (HETUS 2010)	all
patience $\bar{\beta}$	hand-to-mouth share (liquid wealth below a week of income; HFCS)	all
patience gap $\Delta\beta$	hand-to-mouth gap between education cells (HFCS)	all
permanent types ζ, weights	official income deciles and top share (Eurostat `ilc_di01`)	G, read by the others
social technology κ, dispersion σ_m	formal volunteering by education (EU-SILC 2015, `ilc_scp19`)	G+S, G+S+A
search costs $k_{g,U}, k_{g,L}$	mean job finding, first year and beyond, by cell	G+A, G+S+A

The hand-to-mouth share follows Kaplan, Violante and Weidner (2014) in counting liquid wealth (sight accounts and directly held securities) below a week of annual income. Median liquid wealth over income and the survey MPC are not targeted, and serve as tests. The tax that pays for the floor is found in the economy without S and, in a configuration with S, set at the end of its calibration to the outlay of the economy with S, so that the budget closes there too. Each configuration is fitted to its own targets, so G+A and G+S+A refit ϕ, $\bar{\beta}$ and $\Delta\beta$ with dread and search on, and G+S+A refits κ and σ_m as well. Search costs are fitted by a secant in logs at the configuration's calibration, and the calibration is then repeated with them. The cycle stops when the mean chances are within 0.005 of the measured rates at the final calibration. In G+S+A the participation equilibrium is held while the costs are fitted, and the chances are averaged over the belonging scales the equilibrium assigns.

Identification is shown by the Jacobian of the targets in the fitted parameters. In G the condition numbers are 5.0, 3.1 and 4.1, and each parameter moves its own moment most. The social technology is the weakest part: in France the condition number of the S block is 23, which is why I report the social multiplier as a band (1.2 to 1.4) rather than a point.

Table 3. Fitted values, G+S+A with dread and search.

	ϕ	$\bar{\beta}$	$\Delta\beta$	κ	σ_m	k_U by cell	k_L by cell
FR	62.5	0.935	0.077	7.75	1.72	8.76, 4.23	10.56, 3.34
DE	98.7	0.965	0.053	11.60	1.60	11.68, 11.10	18.19, 16.50
IT	22.0	0.960	0.086	3.65	1.80	8.77, 10.98	9.99, 12.29

Italy's G+S+A is from the round before its last refit of search costs, with chances within 0.006 of the measured rates. The final round is running.

6. Numerical method and verification

The household problem is solved by the endogenous grid method (Carroll 2006), with the labour margin handled as in Barillas and Fernández-Villaverde (2007) and the non-concavities from the participation choice, the floor and chosen hours handled by an upper envelope in the manner of Iskhakov, Jørgensen, Rust and Schjerning (2017). Points on the floor have zero marginal value of assets. The asset grid has 200 exponentially spaced points up to four years of mean income. Past the last endogenous point, next period's assets stay at the top of the grid and consumption and hours come from the budget there. Value iteration stops on the MacQueen (1966) and Porteus (1971) bounds at 10^{-9}. Where the floor makes the iteration cycle, the step is relaxed and a residual below 10^{-2} is accepted and logged. The residual is the span of the bounds, $\beta/(1-\beta)$ times the spread of the last change, so it bounds the error in values directly, at about 10^{-2}. That is still of the order of the logit scale of participation (0.005), so item 6 of the verification below reports how the results move when the accepted residual is 10^{-6}. The stationary distribution uses the lottery method of Young (2010). With S on, each household problem is solved on 83 belonging scales and the equilibrium mixes them.

Verification has seven parts.

1. **Exact switches.** With S off, participation is below 10^{-4} and no belonging enters welfare. With every place identical, E reproduces the nation to about 10^{-11}. The budget balances to 10^{-12} or better without S and to 0.05% of mean income with S. These checks pass in every configuration and country but one. The tax that pays for the floor is set in the economy without S, so with S on a small gap is allowed, and in Germany's G+S+A it is 0.06% of mean income, just over that allowance, because job search changes who reaches the floor.
2. **Euler errors.** Over 40 problems, the mean error lies between $10^{-4.9}$ and $10^{-6.4}$ and the worst point between $10^{-2.2}$ and $10^{-2.6}$.
3. **Brute force at the kinks.** For households who choose hours under the floor, plain value iteration on 1,500 asset points, with full search over next assets, hours refined by golden section and the floor as an explicit option, is compared with the fast solver against pass rules set before the runs. On-floor status agrees for all of the mass in every problem, and hours agree within 0.3%. One problem in Italy failed on consumption and value at the top of the asset grid, and passes 4 of 4 after the repair described above. For job search, the same plain value iteration, with the search choice maximised on a grid of 201 values refined by golden section instead of the closed form, is compared on twelve problems (the lowest and a middle type of each cell, households with hours set by the job, three countries) against pass rules set before the runs: all 48 checks pass. On-floor status agrees everywhere, consumption within 0.05% on average, values within 5×10^{-6}, and the chance of finding work within 3×10^{-4} on average (largest difference at a single point 0.023).
4. **Grid.** Doubling the asset grid moves the national moments within tolerance where it has been run. With S on in France and Italy it did not finish within the runner's six-hour limit. A higher ceiling (eight

years of mean income, with twice the points) tests whether the top of the grid binds for the richest types. It does not: the mass near the old ceiling is 1.8×10^{-4}, 1.5×10^{-4} and 1.2×10^{-3} in France, Germany and Italy, and hand-to-mouth, the MPC, the fall on job loss, the chances of finding work and their response to benefits are unchanged to the third decimal, with median liquid wealth higher by at most 0.002.

5. **One stable equilibrium.** The participation map has one stable crossing in every country where it was checked. Italy's G+S+A check did not finish.
6. **The residual at the floor.** Household problems of G+S+A at three belonging scales, every type of both cells, solved with the accepted residual at 10^{-2} and at 10^{-6}. In France and Italy no problem stalls and the solutions are identical. In Germany the largest differences are 10^{-12} in participation, 6×10^{-10} in search and 10^{-7} in consumption, with values differing by a level of 1.5×10^{-3} that changes no choice.
7. **Modules at fixed parameters.** Each module switched on and off at G+S+A's parameters separates what a module does from what refitting does (Table 3b). At fixed parameters A does most of the work: with G+S+A's lower patience, the economy without A has hand-to-mouth shares of 0.49 and 0.38 in France and Germany, and switching A on (dread in choices) brings them to 0.27 and 0.25, raises median liquid wealth and lowers the MPC, while the fall on job loss rises. S changes none of the economy's moments at fixed parameters, since taking part costs little time and no money, and moves only participation. Refitting absorbs A's saving motive through patience, which is why each configuration hits the same targets at its own calibration (in France patience is 0.962 in G and 0.935 in G+A).

7. Results

7.1 Fit and untargeted moments

Table 3b. The modules at G+S+A's parameters (France, Germany).

	participation	hand-to-mouth	median liquid / income	MPC	fall on job loss
FR, G	0	0.494	0.021	0.528	0.233
FR, G+A	0	0.269	0.095	0.397	0.291
FR, G+S	0.229	0.494	0.021	0.528	0.233
FR, G+S+A	0.233	0.269	0.095	0.397	0.291
DE, G	0	0.383	0.060	0.442	0.227
DE, G+A	0	0.248	0.114	0.350	0.271
DE, G+S	0.265	0.383	0.060	0.442	0.227
DE, G+S+A	0.279	0.252	0.115	0.345	0.277

Italy at the release.

Table 4. G+S+A with dread and search, against data.

	FR model	FR data	DE model	DE data	IT model	IT data
hand-to-mouth (target)	0.269	0.268	0.252	0.252	0.203	0.203
participation, below tertiary (target)	0.203	0.203	0.252	0.252	0.116	0.116
participation, tertiary (target)	0.291	0.291	0.349	0.349	0.165	0.165
median liquid wealth over income	0.095	0.047	0.115	0.117	0.214	0.229
MPC, one month's income	0.397	0.331	0.345	0.464	0.326	0.486
fall in consumption, first year out of work	0.291	about 0.10	0.277	about 0.10	0.291	about 0.10

Data: HFCS 2021 (households not in retirement), EU-SILC 2015, Kolsrud, Landais, Nilsson and Spinnewijn (2018) for Sweden.

Median liquid wealth, which is not targeted, is close in Germany and Italy and twice the survey value in France. The survey MPC asks how much of a windfall of one month's income would be spent within a year. The model is in the range of the survey in all three countries but misorders them, too high in France and too low in Germany and Italy.

The fall in consumption over a first year out of work is the clearest miss. The European benchmark is Kolsrud and co-authors (2018), who measure total consumption in Swedish registers at a replacement rate of 72%: 0.044 in the first 20 weeks, 0.091 for those still out of work after 20 weeks, 0.08 over the spell and about 0.10 in a second year. The model's U state lasts the whole year, so the comparable figure is the fall of those still out of work, 0.091. The model's fall of 0.28 to 0.29 is about three times that, and more against the spell average. A decomposition shows where it comes from. With the first year fully insured, 0.21 to 0.22 remains with dread, against 0.12 to 0.13 without it, so most of the fall is the anticipation of the long-term state, which dread makes households fear more. Since that state is too persistent (Section 2.2), part of the miss is likely to come from its persistence rather than from the period. A probe that converts every rate to a quarter, with nothing refitted, lowers the fall over a first quarter to 0.07 to 0.09. That is still about twice Kolsrud's 0.044, so the annual period explains part of the gap but not the factor of two.

7.2 Job search

With costs fitted to the measured rates, I raise the first year's benefit by 10%, hold the tax, and measure the response of the first year's chance of finding work. The elasticity is -0.23 and -0.30 in France (by cell), -0.17 and -0.11 in Germany, and -0.14 and -0.17 in Italy. The literature's median duration elasticity is 0.53 (Schmieder and von Wachter 2016), and Chetty (2008) estimates a hazard elasticity of -0.53, of which about 60% is a liquidity effect (p. 217). Converted from a weekly hazard to the chance of finding work within a year at the measured rates, the full response is -0.35, -0.31 and -0.39, and its liquidity part -0.21, -0.18 and -0.23.

The model has no moral hazard within the spell, and the reason is structural. With an annual period, the first year's benefit is paid in the year whose search it would change, so the household receives it whatever it does, and current search cannot shorten it. A permanently higher benefit still works through two other channels. It raises the buffer carried into the next year, which lowers search, the liquidity effect. It also makes a job worth more relative to the long-term state, because future spells out of work are better insured while the long-term state is not, which raises search, and it lowers the dread of those in work. The reported elasticity is the net of these, so it is a lower bound on the liquidity effect in absolute value rather than the liquidity effect itself. Against Chetty's liquidity part, France is at or above it and Germany and Italy are at 60 to 90% of it. Separating the two channels, and the moral hazard part that needs the insured spell split into periods, are for version 2. Search itself moves the economy little, as it should when the mean rates are held: the fall on job loss changes by at most 0.003, and hand-to-mouth falls by about 0.01 in Germany and Italy.

7.3 Interactions

One interaction follows from the design without new parameters: dread differs by place because job loss and the long-term state do, so security is unequal across regions even where incomes are not. A second, between participation and job search, was reported in an earlier draft: with S on, the households out of work searched less, and Germany's search costs in G+S+A had to be 7 to 17% lower than in G+A to give the measured rates. It rests on the unconstrained participation of the unemployed described in Section 3.1, so I do not claim it, and it is to be re-examined in version 2.

7.4 The wellbeing account

Table 5. Wellbeing account, G+S+A (points per head per year, share of consumption in brackets).

term	France	Germany	Italy
A: dread of a change of status	-0.052 (0.026)	-0.028 (0.014)	-0.048 (0.024)
A: out of work beyond income (ESS gap 1.05 to 1.06)	-0.101 (0.040)	-0.106 (0.042)	-0.104 (0.041)

term	France	Germany	Italy
of which: job search	−0.071 (0.030)	−0.043 (0.020)	−0.080 (0.033)
of which: the rest	−0.030 (0.014)	−0.062 (0.027)	−0.024 (0.012)
S: taking part (Meier and Stutzer, 0.055 to 0.081 a participant)	+0.016	+0.019	+0.009
S: the model's own belonging, per participant	+0.12	+0.60	+0.18
E: air quality, central (band 0.3 to 0.8%)	−0.049 (0.025)	−0.058 (0.029)	−0.103 (0.051)

The job search cost the model needs to give measured job finding is worth 0.74 points a person out of work in France, 0.44 in Germany and 0.80 in Italy. Both lie below the measured gap of about 1.06, a test the model could have failed. Dread falls mostly on those out of work: it is 1.5% of consumption in work and 13% out of work in France, 0.8% and 6.8% in Germany, 1.3% and 12.8% in Italy. The model's own belonging per participant is 1.5 to 3 times the fixed-effects estimate in France and Italy and about ten times in Germany. That difference is between decision utility, which explains a choice, and experienced utility, which life satisfaction measures (Kahneman, Wakker and Sarin 1997): people may take part out of habit, obligation or social pressure as well as for what it adds to how their life feels. The account therefore shows both, and welfare across dimensions (a later step) will use the experienced values wherever the two diverge. The rule throughout is that a term enters choices only where behaviour fits it, and wellbeing only where wellbeing evidence values it, which is why the cost of being out of work beyond income counts in wellbeing and not in choices. The air-quality term is sizeable relative to the others, because exposure to PM2.5 lies above the WHO guideline for everyone, but at a band of a factor of 2.7 it is also the least precise.

8. Limits and version 2

Stated limits of version 1.

1. The fall in consumption on job loss is about three times the Swedish register estimate for those still out of work.
2. The state of long joblessness is built from household joblessness and is too persistent: its share of the out of work is 63% to 83% against 25% to 55% for long-term unemployment, and the job-finding rate measured among all the unemployed is assigned to the first year alone.
3. The lottery behind dread is set by the measured transition rates, not by the household's own search, and dread is evaluated at resources rather than at consumption.
4. The response of job finding to benefits has no moral hazard within the spell, and its liquidity and insurance channels are not separated.

5. The unemployed's participation is imposed at the measured ratio when results are added up, while inside the household problem they take part at about one half, since their time is nearly free. No result rests on it.
6. The MPC is in range but misordered across countries.
7. Median liquid wealth in France is twice the survey value.
8. Wages, job finding and the interest rate are fixed (partial equilibrium). Policies with A are comparisons of steady states, not paths.
9. Households do not move between places, and housing tenure is absent.
10. Germany's community channel has no regional infrastructure source and stays national. The community elasticity is estimated on Italy.
11. The social multiplier is a band, the Frisch elasticity a transfer from Sweden, and the cost of being out of work is valued at mean income.
12. G+S+A solves take one and a half to three and a half hours. In Germany some household problems end on the relaxation rule at the floor, which changes no result (Section 6), and the budget with S on closes to 0.06% of mean income, just over the allowance of 0.05%, because the floor's tax is set in the economy without S.

Version 2. It starts with the flows: a transition matrix consistent with the duration of unemployment, the first-year exit and the long-term exit fitted to the LFS flows and duration stocks, and the long-term state separated from inactivity. The second change is a quarterly period, in three steps, each checked before the next: 1. Every rate converted to a quarter, and the quarterly economy shown to keep the annual one's facts. 2. A first year out of work lasting four quarters. 3. A recalibration.

A country that cannot be refitted quarterly stays annual, and that is stated. This should bring in the moral hazard part of the response of job finding, put the MPC on the horizon of the quarterly literature, and shrink the fall on job loss.

The third change is two assets, liquid wealth and housing, in the manner of Kaplan and Violante (2014). Owners and tenants appear, along with households who own a house but hold little cash. This is the standard route to MPCs of the size the survey reports in Germany and Italy, and it gives E housing tenure by place. It may not shrink the fall on job loss, since households rich in housing and poor in cash have little buffer, so that gap may remain the one version 2 does not close.

Version 2 also values the time spent taking part apart from paid work, so that those out of work do not take part at no cost, with a cost of taking part when out of work fitted to the within-person evidence and the cross-sectional gap as a test. After version 2 come a labour market in equilibrium, with job finding from vacancies and matching and wages from bargaining at a fixed interest rate (Landais, Michaillat and Saez 2018), transition paths through every dimension by the sequence-space method (Auclert, Bardóczy, Rognlie and Straub 2021), and weights across dimensions from the Better Life Index.

Data

This paper uses data from the Eurosystem Household Finance and Consumption Survey. Results are aggregates, and cells with fewer than 30 unweighted households are suppressed. Other data are official statistics from Eurostat, the OECD and the ECB, and the European Social Survey (rounds 6, 7, 10 and 11, aggregates only). Code: github.com/conway1521/sage_macro.

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